communities on part of Gaza's territory? Nothing coming from members of our coalition astonishes anymore.

Today, Gallant issued some sort of half-baked apology for what happened. Totally insufficient. As defense minister, he will have to pay the full price. In the meantime, he told soldiers "to get ready to see Gaza from the inside."

In his speech to the nation, President Biden grouped Hamas with Putin, in terms of their attempts to destroy two democracies. He made clear that international law and humanitarian rules had to be respected, clearly addressing future Israeli operations in Gaza. Tomorrow, he plans to ask Congress for a package of $14 billion in military aid for Israel. All in all, the president will be asking Congress for $105 billion. An American destroyer located in the northern Red Sea, the *USS Carney*, downed nineteen long-range Houthi missiles directed at Israel.

Friday, October 20

The missiles fired at Israel from Yemen came very shortly after Iran threatened that new fronts would be activated against "the Zionist entity"; their interception by an American destroyer showed that the United States was ready to intervene. Iran probably wanted to check whether the Americans would stand by their word. The Americans sent a clear signal that they would. Now comes the hard part—to get really involved or not. For the time being, the answer seems to be to stay on the sidelines, but the real test will come with Israeli ground forces' imminent entry into Gaza. This will be the turning point of the war.

For Israel to be ready to take the next step, it needs strong leadership. It does not have any at all. The government is a chaotic heap and its head is a dead man walking. Thus, Israel's entry into Gaza could become a tragedy, for both the soldiers and Palestinians. A new poll has confirmed what a